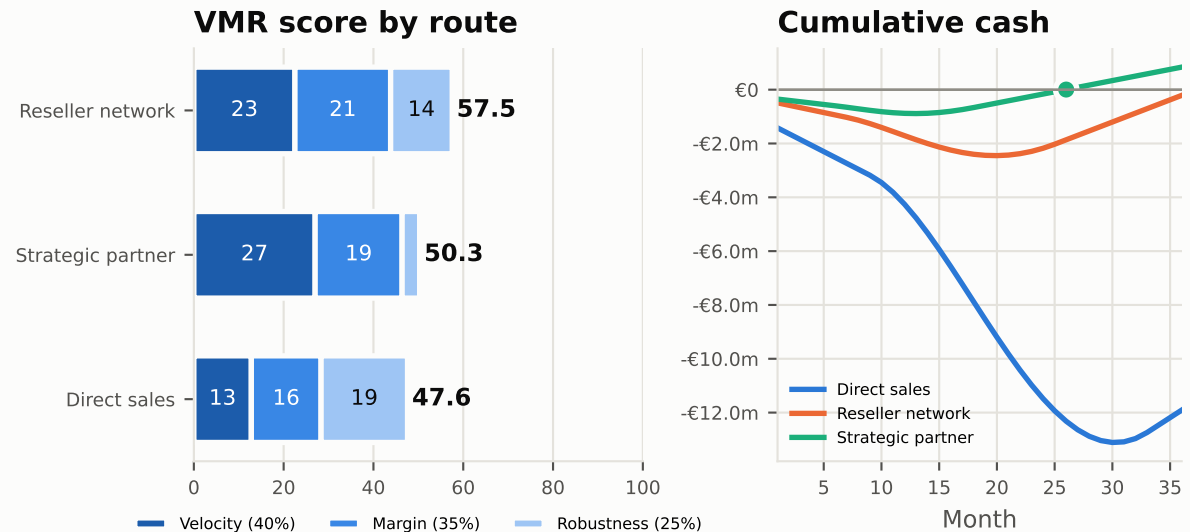


Enter through the reseller network. It scores 58/100 on VMR against 50 for the strategic partner, the strongest balance of speed, profit and resilience.

Mid-market B2B software company entering a new European country. Three routes scored on Velocity, Margin and Robustness over 36 months. All data synthetic.

Why

- 1 Against the runner-up (Strategic partner) it gains 1.9 on Margin and 9.8 on Robustness, and gives up 4.5 on Velocity (weighted points).
- 2 It breaks even at month 37 (projected), needs peak funding of €2.5m and runs at a 29% cash margin by month 36.
- 3 It ranks first in 54% of all possible Velocity/Margin/Robustness weightings, so the result does not hinge on the exact default weights.



It stops winning if

1. Velocity weight above 64% (default 40%): Strategic partner ranks first.
2. Robustness weight above 48% (default 25%): Direct sales ranks first.
3. Robustness weight below 8% (default 25%): Strategic partner ranks first.
4. The reseller network's channel take is 25% higher than assumed (30% to 38%): Strategic partner ranks first.

Top three risks

1. Assumption risk: if gross margin is 18% lower than assumed, Direct sales overtakes.
2. Cash exposure: cumulative cash bottoms at -€2.5m and breakeven comes at month 37 (projected); in the downside case it moves to month 56 (projected).
3. Downside exposure: in the downside case (market -30%, main intermediary lost in month 18) it keeps only 63% of base-case revenue.

Next steps

1. Test the two assumptions that move the ranking most before committing: the reseller network's channel take and the strategic partner's channel take.
2. Set a go/no-go review at month 17, half-way through the ramp, against the base-case revenue curve.
3. Keep the strategic partner as the fallback. It becomes the better route if the reseller network's channel take is 25% higher than assumed (30% to 38%).